Back up and share your MakeCode game

Digital Technologies · School and personal computers

You will

- save a copy of your game as a file in Google Drive
- make a link so others can play your game
- open a backup file in MakeCode

You need

- your game open in MakeCode Arcade, signed in (see the guide Sign in and save your MakeCode game)
- Google Drive (G:) in File Explorer (see the guide Sign in to Google Drive for desktop)

Before you start

- The file looks like a picture of a game cartridge, but your whole game is inside it. Keep the file as it is: a screenshot of it is only a picture.
- Name each backup with a version: `my-game-v0.1`, then `v0.2` and so on.

 Click here  Look here

1

MakeCode › Editor

Click the **Save** button (the disk) next to your game's name at the bottom.

A Save As window opens.



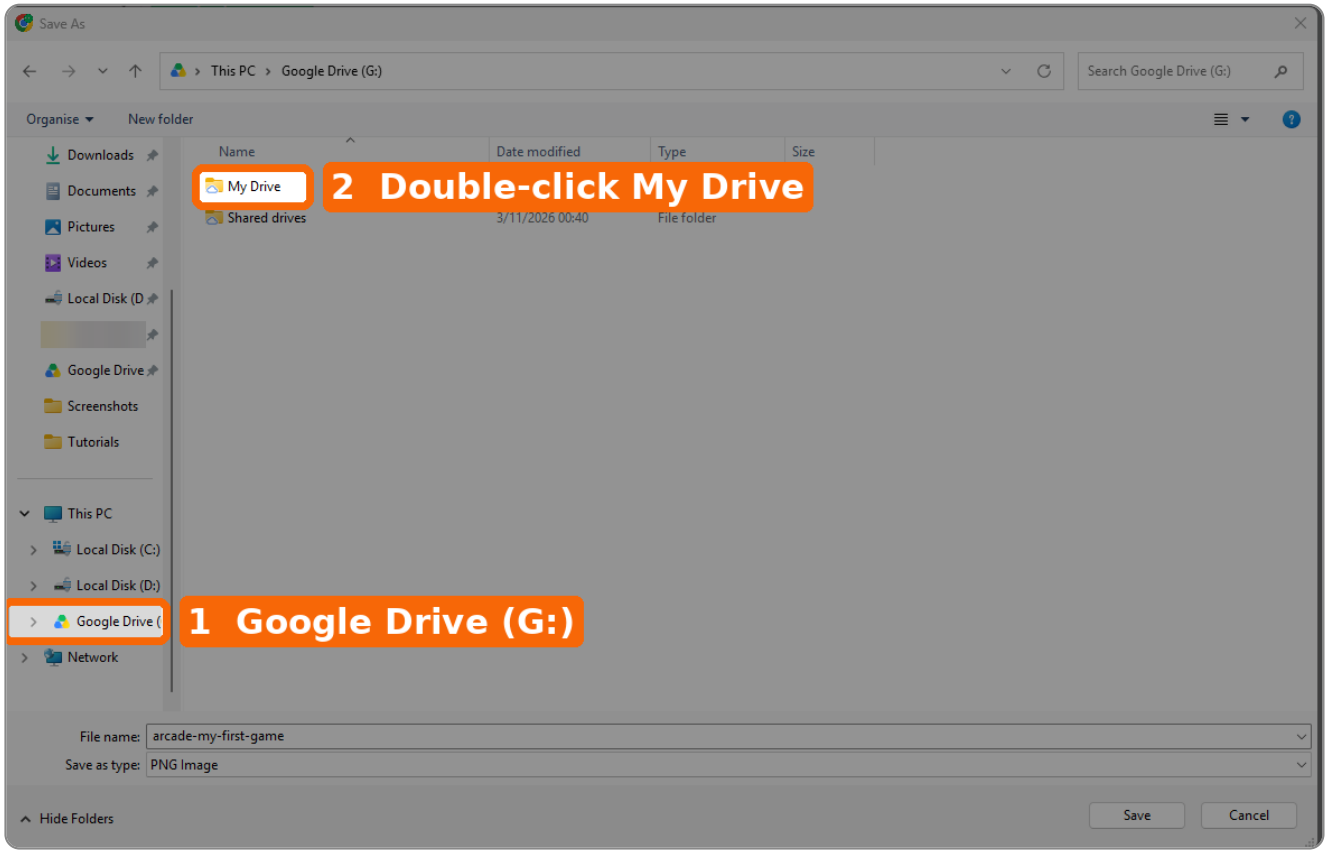
2

Save As

In the left pane, click **Google Drive (G:)**.

Double-click **My Drive**.

If something goes wrong
No Google Drive (G:): Google Drive for desktop isn't signed in. See the guide Sign in to Google Drive for desktop.



3

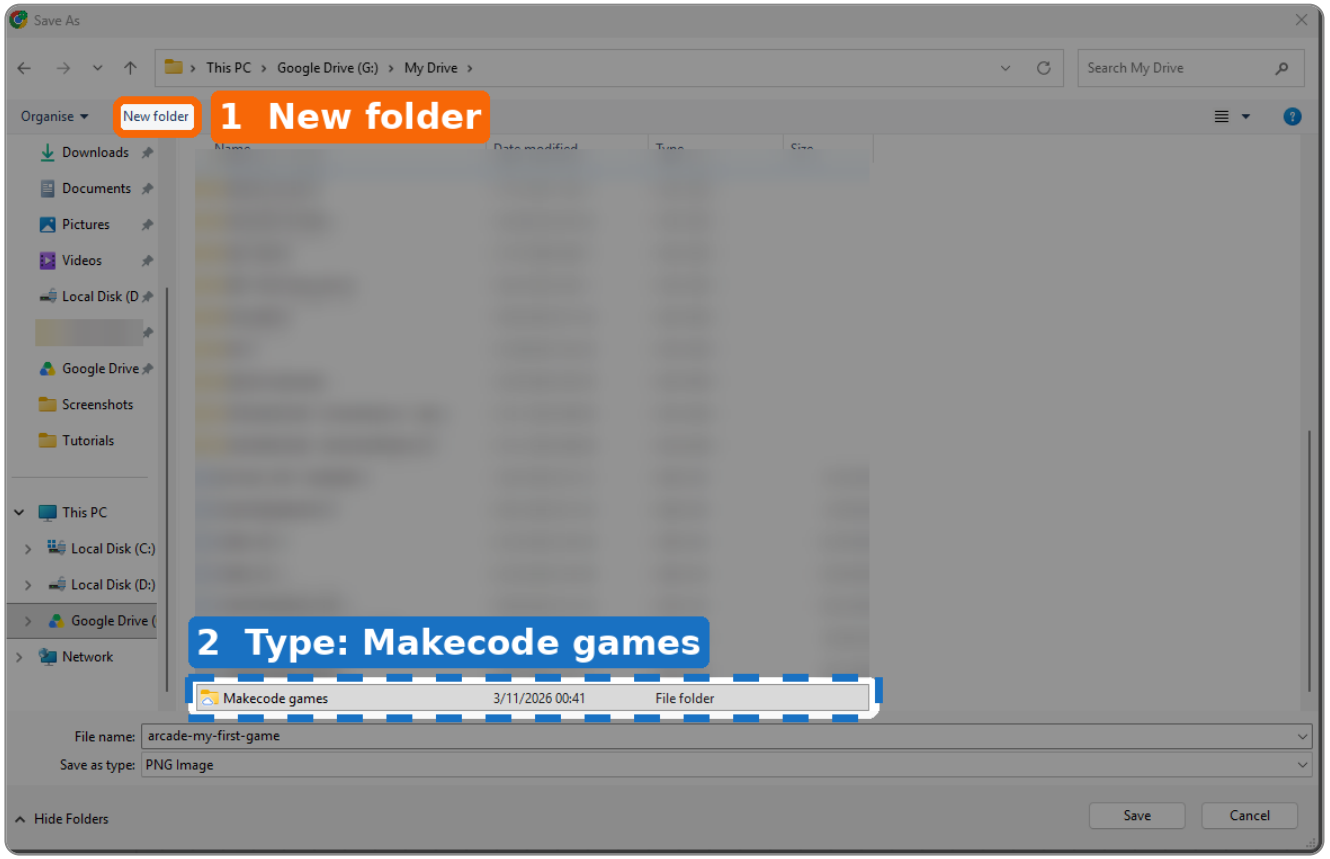
Save As › My Drive

Click **New folder**.

Type `Makecode games` and press `Enter`.

Double-click the new folder to open it.

Make this folder once. Next time, just double-click it.



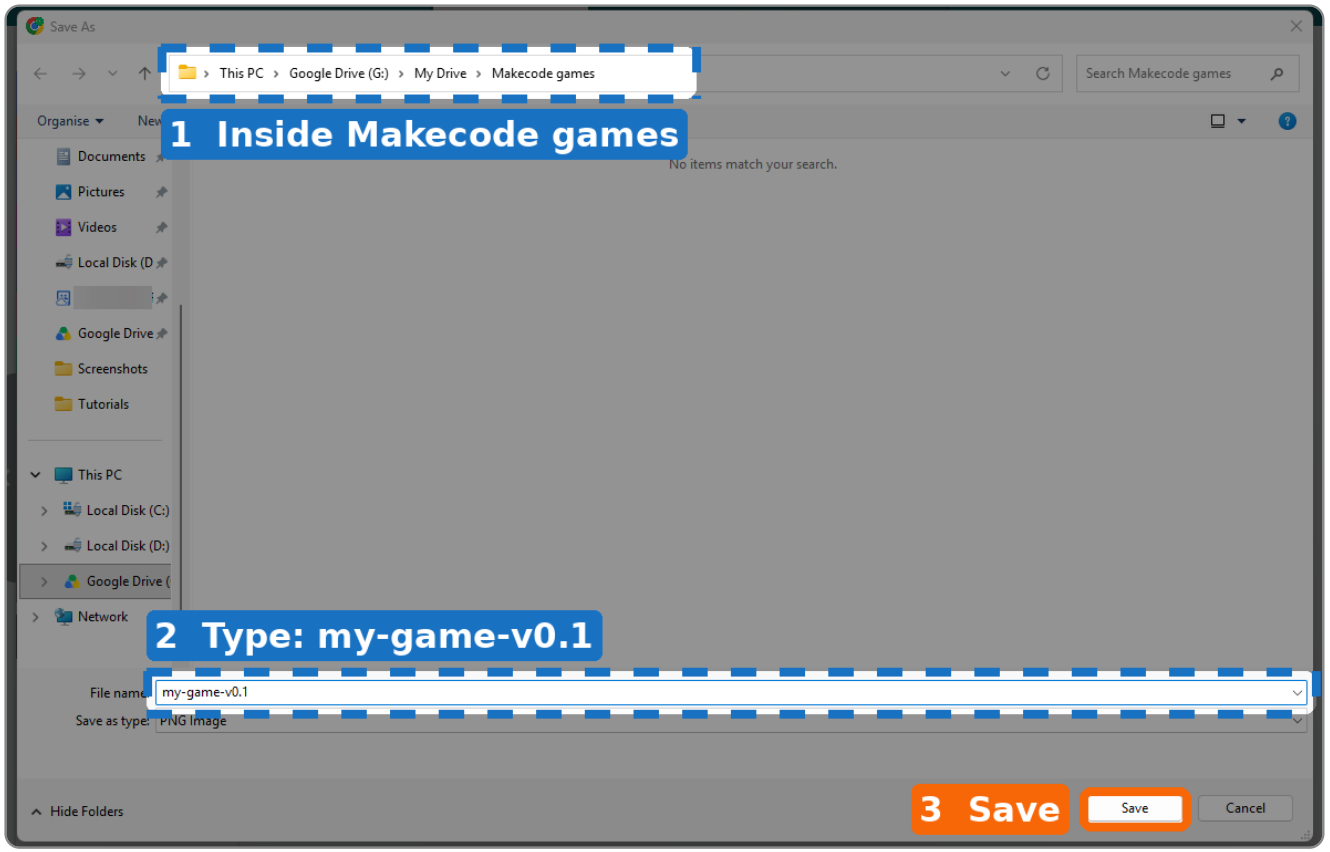
4

Save As › Makecode games

Check the path ends in Makecode games.

In **File name**, type your game's name and version, like `my-game-v0.1`.

Click **Save**.

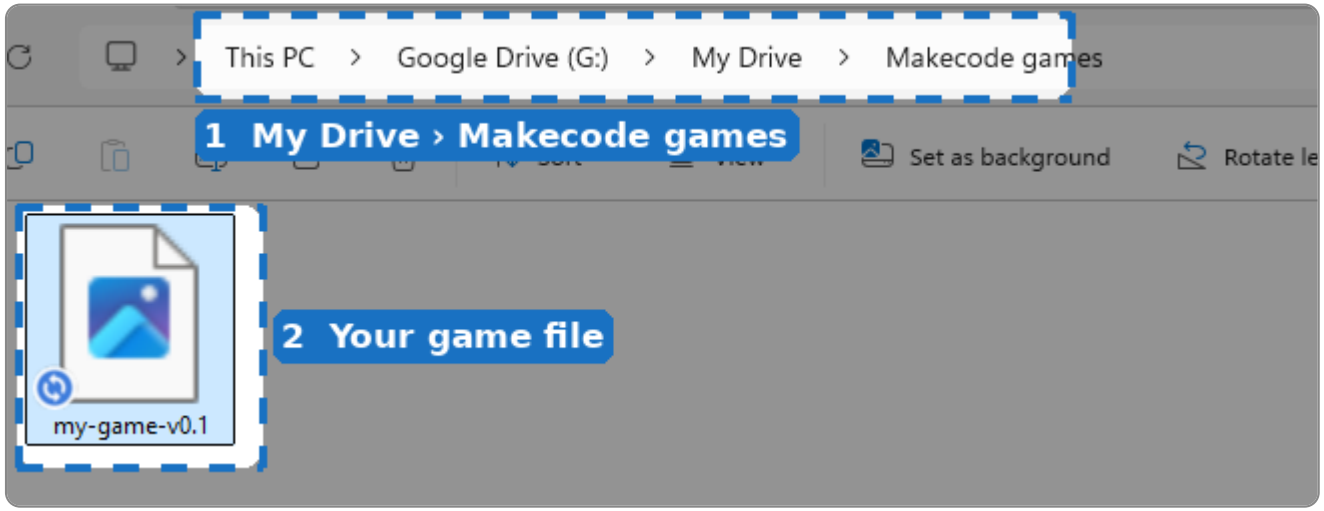


5

File Explorer › Google Drive (G:) › My Drive › Makecode games

Open the folder in File Explorer to check your file is there.

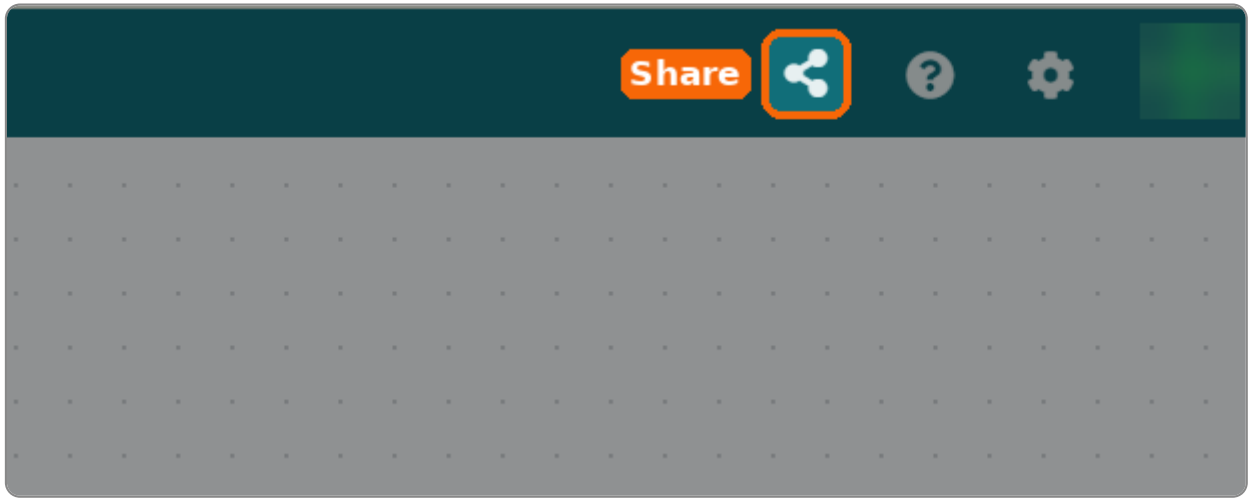
> **Check:** your game file, with the version in its name.



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MakeCode › Editor

Click **Share** (top right).



7

MakeCode › Share Project

Check your game's name.

Click **Share Project**.

Anyone with the link can play your game, so keep personal details out of it.



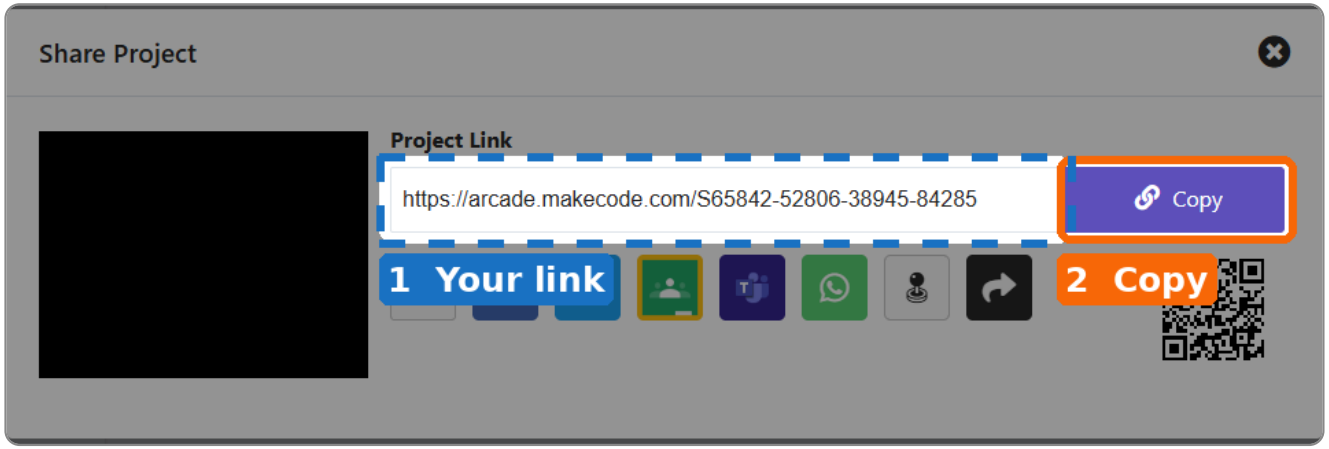
8

MakeCode › Share Project

Click **Copy**.

Paste the link where your kaiako asks, like your Google Classroom assignment.

Signed in, your link stays the same. After changes, update it (see the last page).



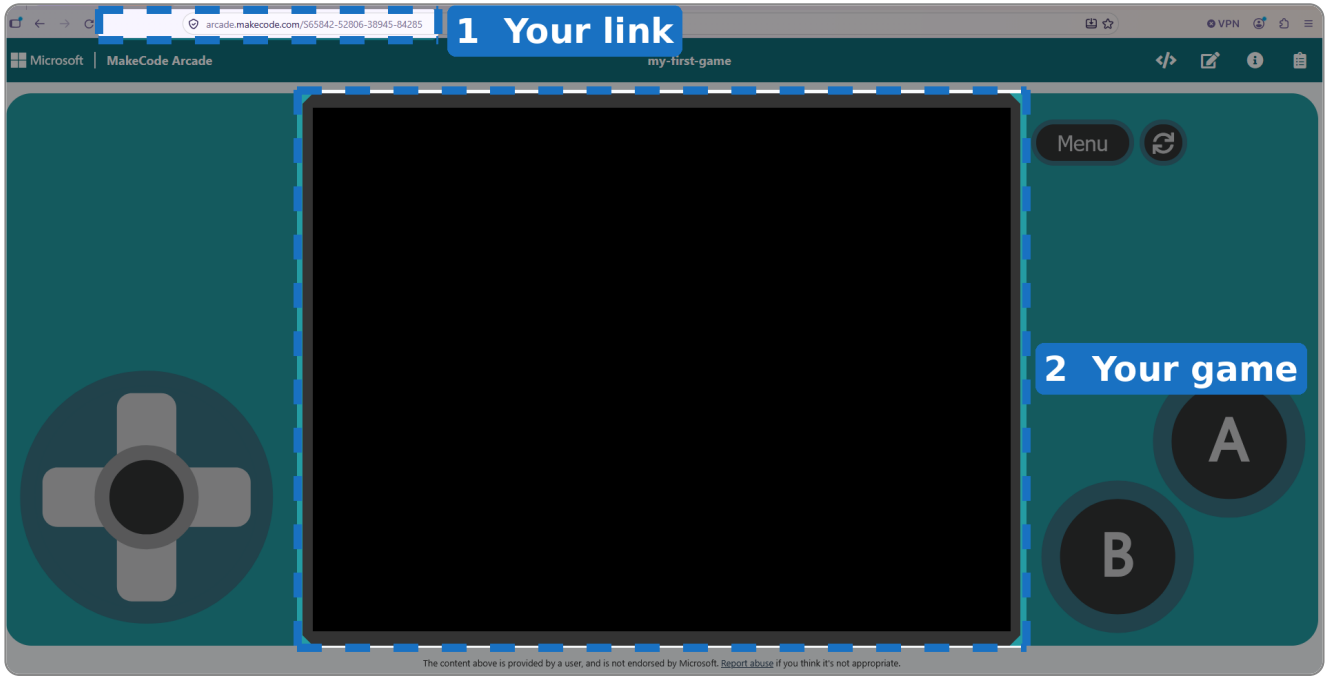
9

Any browser › New tab

Paste the link into a new tab and press Enter.

Any browser works, even without signing in.

> **Check:** your game plays from the link.



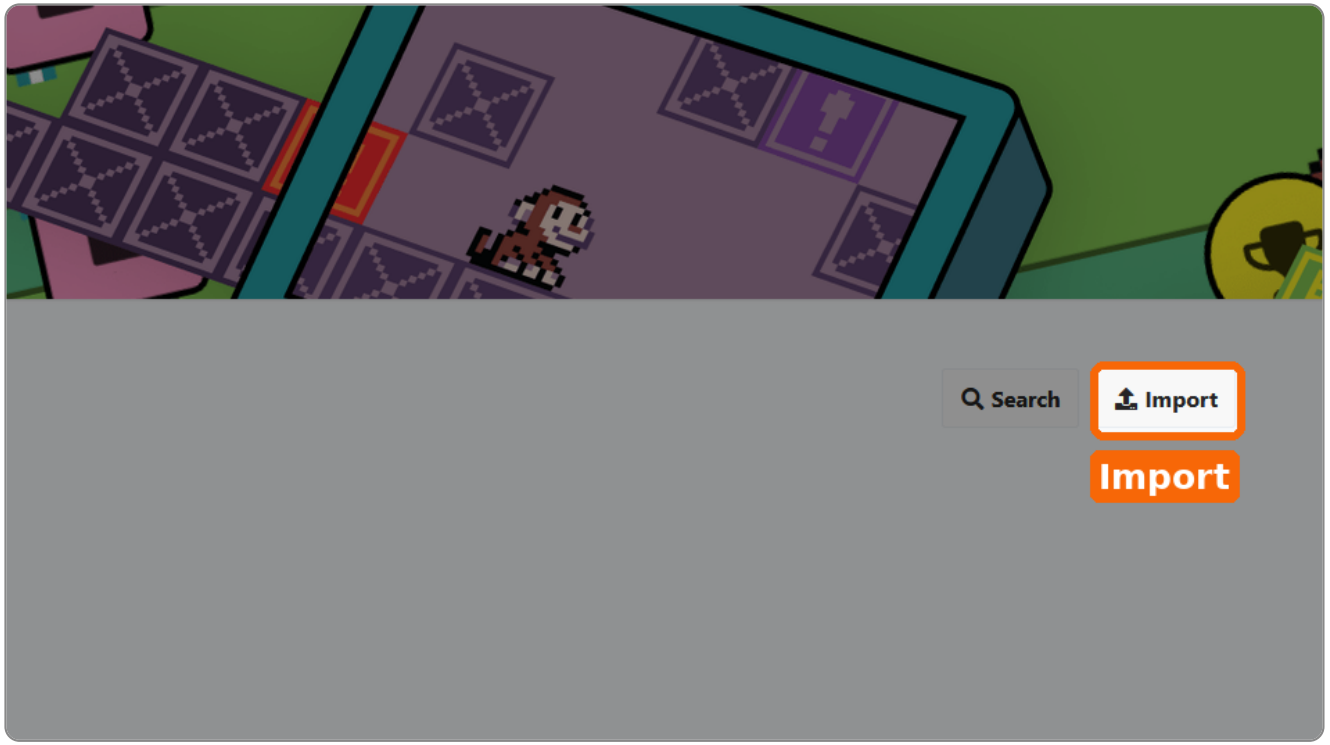
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MakeCode › Home

To open a backup, go to the MakeCode home page.

Click **Import**.

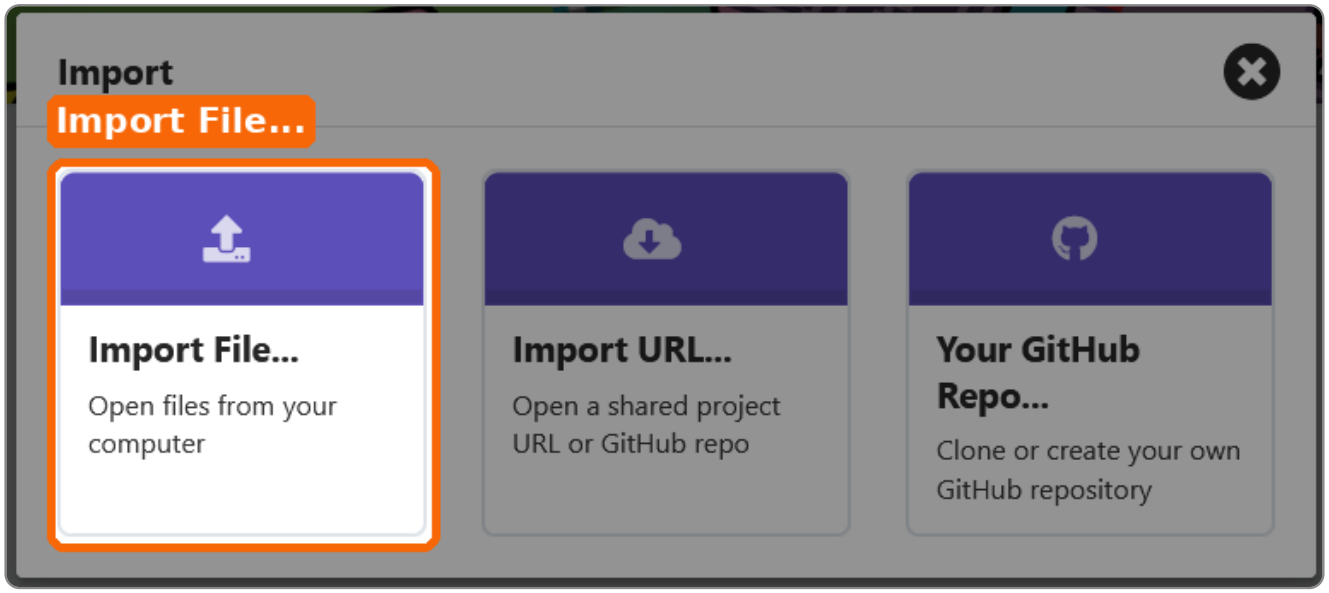
Use this when your game goes missing, or to open an older version.



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MakeCode › Import

Click **Import File...**

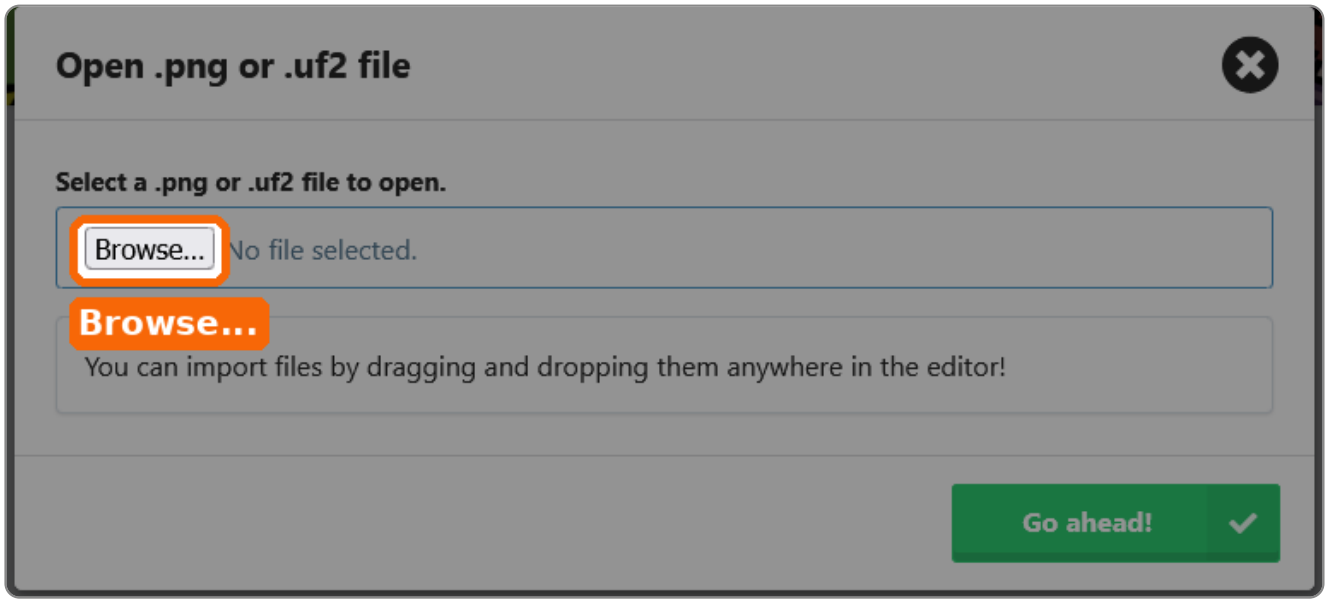


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MakeCode › Open .png or .uf2 file

Click **Browse...**

Or drag your game file from File Explorer onto MakeCode.



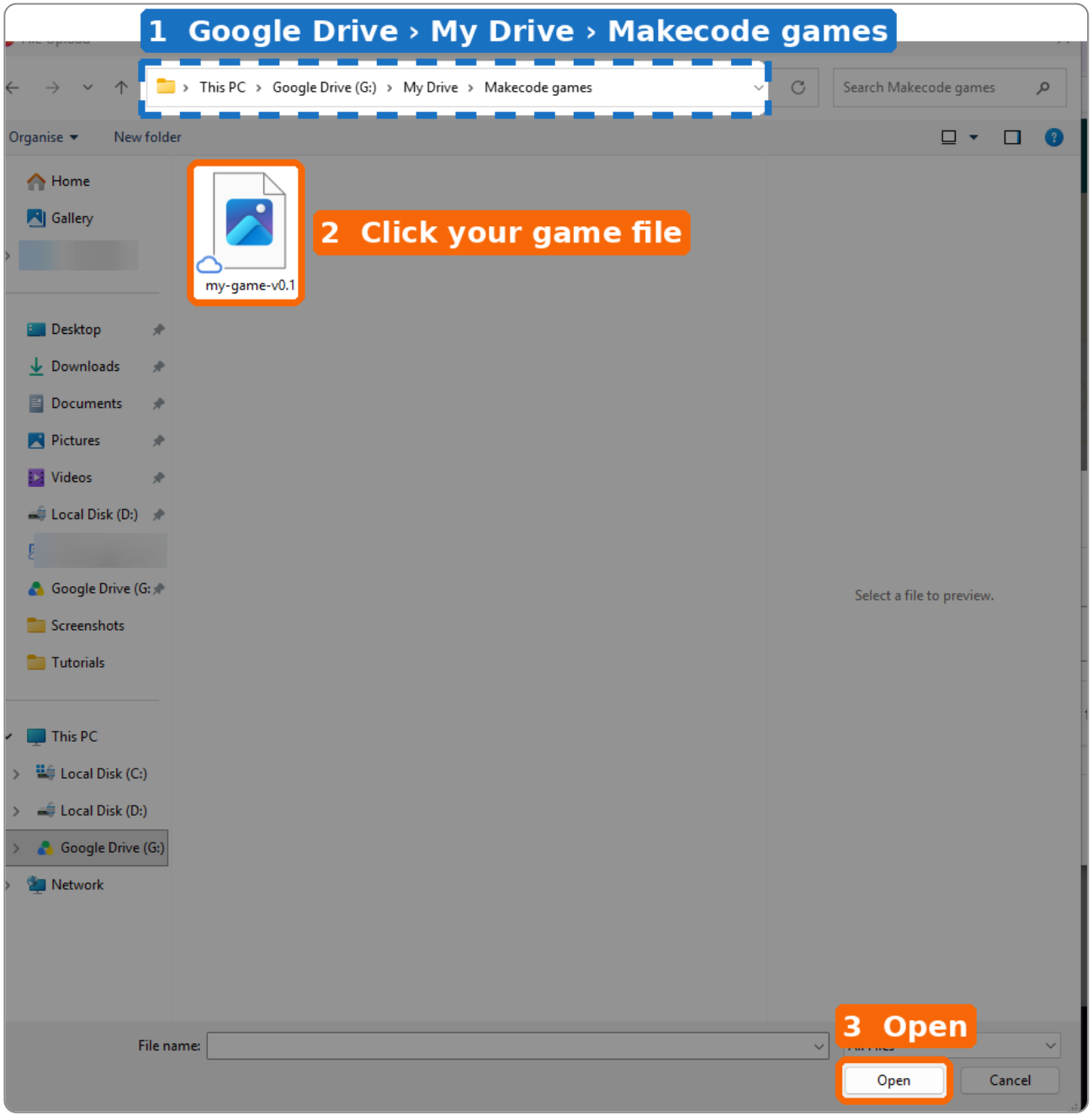
13

Open

Go to Google Drive (G:) › My Drive › Makecode games.

Click your game file.

Click **Open**.



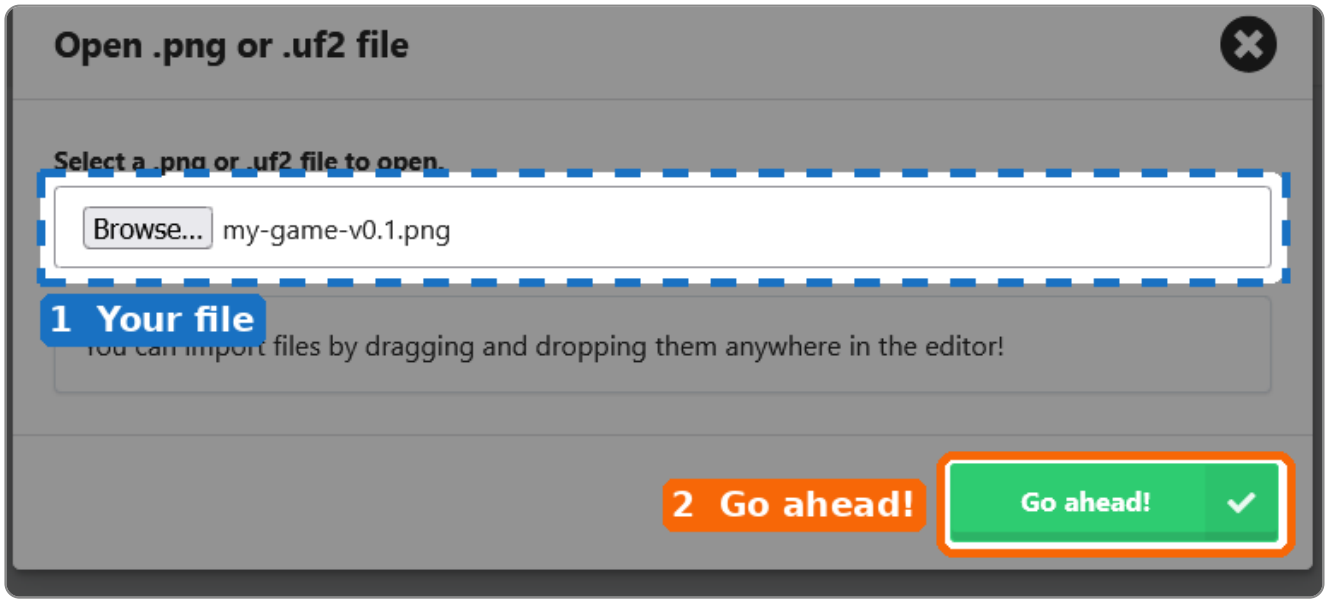
14

MakeCode › Open .png or .uf2 file

Check your file's name.

Click **Go ahead!**

> **Check:** your game opens in the editor, ready to keep working.



Update your link
After you change your game, click **Share**, tick **Update existing share link for this project**, then share. Your link stays the same and shows the new version.

Back up often
Save a new file each time you hand in or finish a big change: `my-game-v0.1`, `my-game-v0.2`… Older versions stay safe in Makecode games.

Checkpoint

- [ ] I can save my game as a file in Google Drive.
- [ ] I can copy a link that plays my game.
- [ ] I can open a backup file in MakeCode.